

Problem 2. Taa (20 marks)

The Taa language is spoken by around 2,500 people in Botswana and Namibia. Taa is famous for being the language with the largest number of distinct sounds in the world— according to some counts, it has over 160. It includes a wide variety of click consonants (like the sound of tsk or tut in English), marked by the letters !, |, ||, †, and '. For example, the name of the language, **!Xóǎ** has a click itself.

Below are some sentences in Taa with their English translations. Note that *buchu powder* is a medicinal mix of herbs. **ǎ, aǎ, ǵa, ae, ua, ǵǎ, ǵe,** and **uǎ** are vowels, and the symbols **ó, ǝ, ô,** and **ō** mark tone.



1. **èh |ǎ gǎǎ ní káni kǎ dtshǎǎ**
His duck wants the buchu powder.
2. **èh à gùm kǎ èh |ǎ †ǎǎ tǎ dàǎ à |nǵa kǎ**
He ate his bone that the polecat looked at.
3. **ǎ |ǎ dàǎ ||quǎ ní dt'kx'àba ke èh |e bòkòsè**
My young polecat is stuck in his box.
4. **|ǎ gǎǎ ní ||qhúa káni ke bòkòsè !xae**
Does the duck not want the big box?
5. **ǎ à kùhm ke dàhbe te ní dt'kx'àba kǎ †ǎǎ ke**
I touched the mudwasp that is stuck to the bone.
6. **|é èh ní ||xũ kǎ dtshǎǎ**
Does he throw away the buchu powder?
7. **|é dàhbe ||qhae à ||qhúa kùhm kǎ ||xǎǎ |ǎ †gúǎ**
Did another mudwasp not touch the men's egg?
8. **qáe ní ||qhúa káni kǎ ||gǎ'ǎ !xaǎ tǎ à kùhm ke dō'le ||que kǎ**
The woman does not want the big springbok that touched the new grass.

Q 2.1 Translate the following sentences into English:

9. **|é ǎ à gùm ke dàhbe ||que te à káni kǎ †gúǎ ke**
10. **|ǎ ||xǎǎ ní ||qhúa gùm kǎ dtshǎǎ tǎ ǎ à kùhm kǎ**
11. **qáe |ǎ ||gǎ'ǎ tǎ èh ní |nǵa kǎ à dt'kx'àba ke dō'le**

Q 2.2 Translate the following sentences into Taa:

12. *Do I throw away the polecat's big bone that is not stuck to my new box?*
13. *Does the young woman that I looked at eat the new buchu powder?*
14. *He did not want another egg that the men touched.*
15. *Did another springbok that doesn't touch the polecat throw away the duck's egg?*

Q 2.3 Explain your solution.